2015 Toyota Prius Four

$7,500 · 170,000 miles · Private seller · Northridge, CA

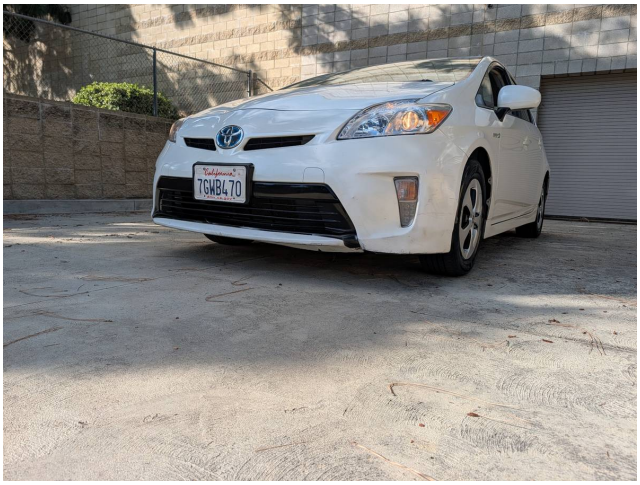
Seller: Private seller

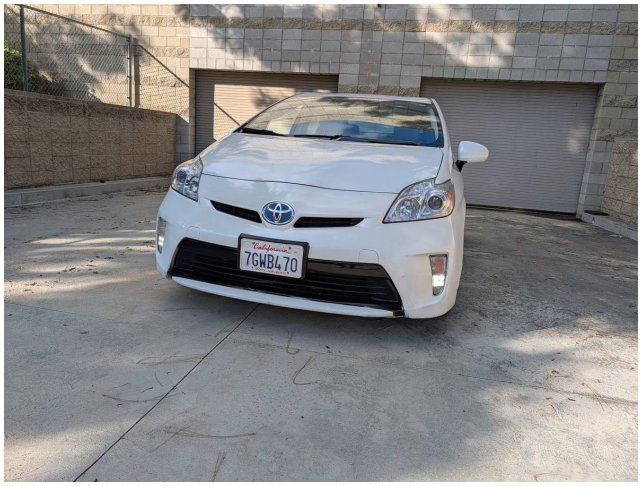
Source: Craigslist

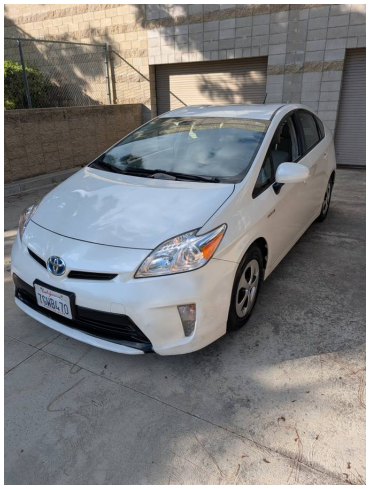
Listing: https://www.craigslist.org/view/d/granada-hills-2015-toyota-prius-hybrid/nwU3ENwm1P5wKFzQrQkauY

Report generated November 04, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder









+ 2 more photos in the app.

Out-the-door price	Monthly cost to own	Reliability
$8,430	**$465**	**Average**
Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare.	loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration	3/5 · 1 recalls · 166 NHTSA complaints

Budget — buying it

Vehicle price	$7,500.00
Use tax (9.25%) — paid at DMV	$693.75
Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price)	$48.75
Registration + CHP fee	$108.00
Transportation improvement fee	$65.00
Title transfer	$15.00
Total out-the-door	$8,430.50
+ Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop)	$150.00

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

Budget — paying for it

Down payment	$5,000.00
Amount financed	$3,430.50
Monthly loan payment (60 mo @ 7.5% APR)	$68.74
Total interest over the loan	$693.91
Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection)	$5,150.00

Budget — owning it each month

Loan payment	$68.74
Insurance (estimate, full)	$135.00
Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 50 MPG, $4.75/gal)	$95.00
Maintenance & repair reserve	$150.00
Registration renewal (÷12)	$16.56
Total per month	$465.30

Running costs without the loan: **$397/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$13,577** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

Insurance

Coverage	Typical Ridgecrest range	Estimate used
Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15)	$49–$112/mo	$70/mo
Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive)	$94–$243/mo	$135/mo

The budget above uses the **full coverage** estimate ($135/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: typical car. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

Reliability

Rating: Average (3/5)

Last year of the gen-3 Prius, in top trim, from a private seller with a clean title. 170k is right where the gen-3 EGR and head-gasket problem can show up, so the service history matters.

NHTSA data for this model year: 1 recalls · 166 owner complaints (29 involving a crash). Most complaints: Service Brakes (93), Electrical System (27), Unknown Or Other (15), Power Train (13), Engine (8), Forward Collision Avoidance (7).

Known issues for this model

• EGR valve/cooler clogging can lead to head-gasket failure around 150-200k (ask if the EGR has been cleaned)

• Inverter coolant pump (covered by a recall; check it was done)

• Hybrid battery age: budget about $1,500-2,500 for a refurbished pack if it weakens

• Brake booster/actuator failure on some cars

Check on this car before buying

• Get the VIN: check recalls and run a history report

• Hybrid battery health scan

• Check coolant level and for white smoke or overheating

• Pre-purchase inspection before paying

Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

[ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price

[ ] Recalls checked / completed

[ ] Clean title in seller's name

[ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills

[ ] No overheating; coolant clean

[ ] Pre-purchase inspection

[ ] VIN decoded & matches listing

[ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)

[ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)

[ ] A/C cold after 15+ min

[ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)

[ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.